adopted a large number of girl children. We have taken the responsibility of providing for all their needs. We are also working to prevent the occurrence of anaemia among women.
Yashoda Group has adopted 5100 TB patients in Ghaziabad.

I am also associated with Special Olympics Bharat. It uses the vehicle of sports to transform the lives of children with intellectual disabilities.

One derives a lot of satisfaction by being of use to the deprived sections of society. In fact, through the medium of this interview, I would urge all those with the means to do their bit to make a difference in the lives of the underprivileged.

IN THE FIELD OF HEALTHCARE, PATIENTS' TRUST IS OF UTMOST SIGNIFICANCE. WHAT HOLDS THE KEY TO WINNING THAT CONFIDENCE?

There was a time when doctors were revered. The relationship was of mutual respect. But of late that has changed. There is now a trust deficit. I don't think any doctor deliberately tries to harm his patients. But it is important for medical professionals to maintain transparency. They should help the patient understand the exact nature of his situation so that the patient can make informed decisions. While imparting treatment it is also important to add human touch so that the patient and his family feel comfortable. Communication is of utmost importance in the field of healthcare. So we provide specialised training to our employees to prevent instances of communication gaps. Our patients are our brand ambassadors. We don't go out splurging on marketing ourselves, instead, we focus on winning the trust of our patients, who then recommend us to others.

AND YOUR EFFORTS HAVE RECEIVED RECOGNITION IN THE FORM OF VARIOUS AWARDS. WHICH ARE THE ONES PARTICULARLY GRATIFYING?

We are grateful to have received numerous awards and recognitions for our efforts. While our trophy cabinet is ever-expanding, I strongly feel that it is the letters that our patients leave for us that we are most grateful for.

DO YOU THINK THE PANDEMIC HAS BROUGHT ANY (MAJOR) CHANGES IN PEOPLE'S APPROACH TOWARDS HEALTHCARE?

During the COVID-19 pandemic, the nature of the virus required the patients to be kept in isolation. Staying away from their loved ones posed an emotional challenge for the patients and their kin. At most hospitals, even the doctors were reluctant to pay multiple visits to the COVID wards. But at our hospitals, our doctors and members of the nursing staff, remained actively involved in the treatment. They would regularly visit the patients and offer them assurance and emotional support, apart from the medical treatment. That really helped us earn a lot of great reviews.

An important lesson that the pandemic has taught is the unpredictability of life. Additionally, post-pandemic the cases of heart attacks too have increased massively. All that has made people more conscious about their health. They are no longer callous about their ailments and seek professional help for them.

WHAT CAN BE DONE TO MAKE PEOPLE MEDICALLY FURTHER AWARE SO THAT THEY CAN GET TIMELY TREATMENT?

There is an adage that states prevention is better than cure. People should get annual health checkups done. Also, there is a pressing need to make lifestyle changes. Most people, owing to their busy professional schedules, spend a large part of the day on chairs. Such a sedentary lifestyle is the root of various diseases. Health is wealth. If one is battling a life-threatening disease, everything around the patient comes to a standstill. So not giving due importance to health when one still has time, can be lethal.

Mental health is an area which is not given due attention. Most people battling mental health issues do not head for medical help. It is still taboo in our society. This is despite the increase in mental health problems post the pandemic. We constantly keep organising mental health awareness campaigns to make this concern a part of public discourse.

WHAT ARE THE FUTURE PLANS OF THE GROUP?

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has placed a lot of emphasis on medical tourism. Nearly 2 million patients visit India each year from 78 countries for medical, wellness and IVF treatments. We want to contribute further to provide a greater boost to this industry. We want to do our bit to help India gain recognition as the best destination for healthcare in the world.
Indian medical professionals are playing a key role in the growth of the healthcare industries in the UK & the US. So there is no dearth of Indian talent. We want to open our centres in foreign countries as well and showcase to the world the various technologically advanced & traditionally rich treatment methods of India.

